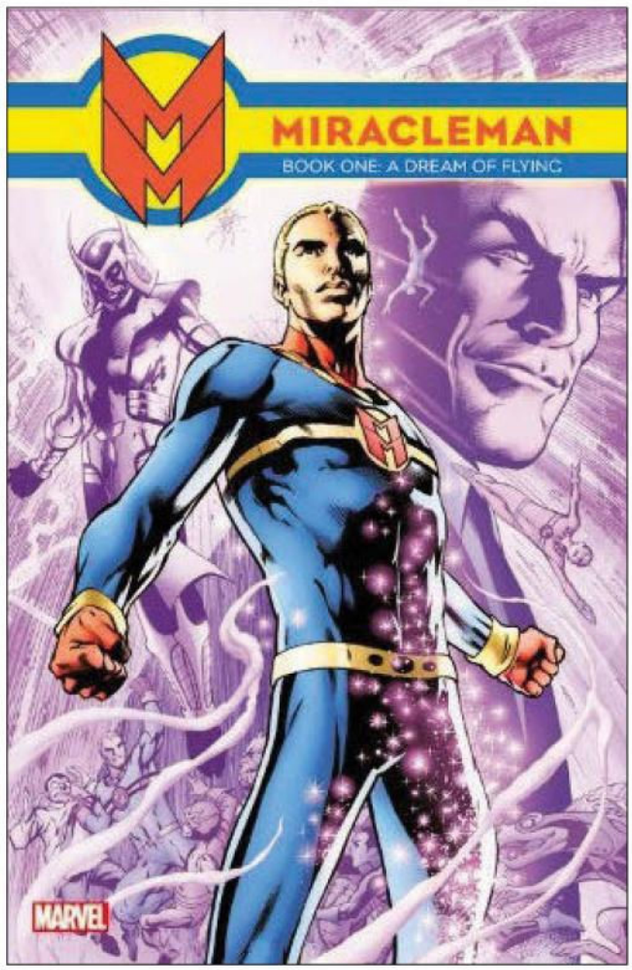
MIRACLEMAN

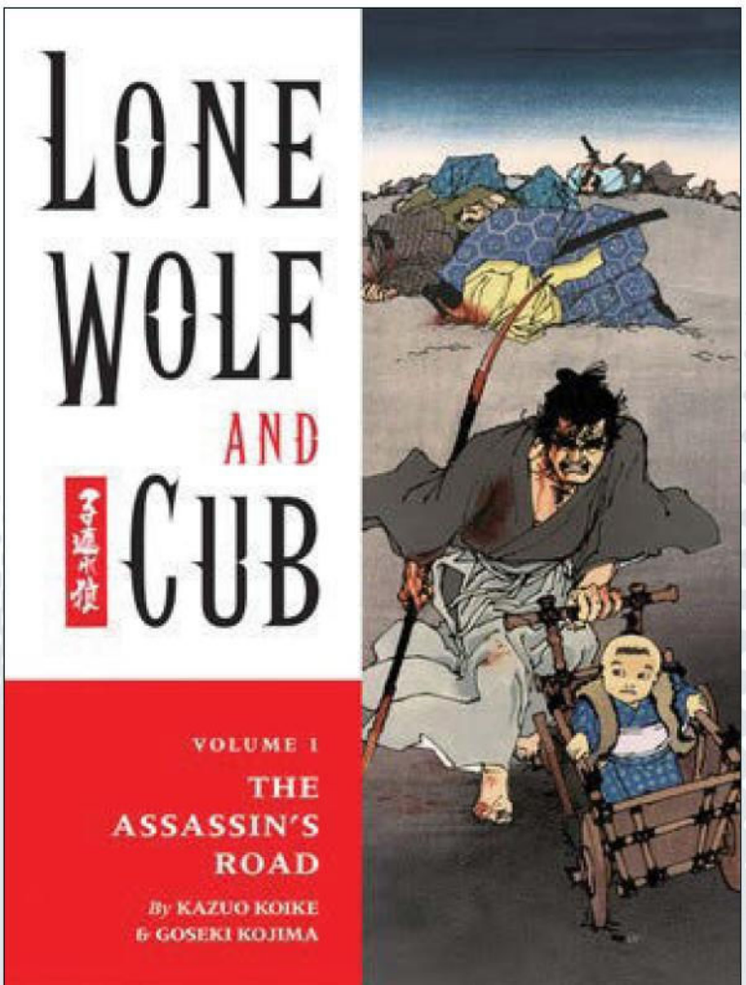
Details **Originally published** Warrior #1-21 (1982) **Publisher** L Miller & Son **Writer** Alan Moore **Artist** Garry Leach
Collected in Minuteman: Vol 1 – A Dream Of Flying **Available digitally** Comixology, Marvel, Digital Unlimited



After Alan Moore took on the *Marvelman* reboot in 1982, he characteristically took the hero in a much darker direction, changing the name to *Miracleman* in 1985 due to Marvel taking issue with the original name. It was Moore's first fumbling with superhero fiction – and in it, you can see him touch upon themes that would later come to define his work in comics: from the superhero as a source of disquiet and Byronic villains to the deconstruction of superhero fiction.



It's worth reading Moore's run on *Miracleman* in order to understand Britain's overall place in the comics world, and see how Moore took a semi-legal hero (Miracleman began life as a Captain Marvel rip-off) and define him with his own dark fantasies in an age of Thatcher-lead political tension, nuclear paranoia and punk-rock mentality. Moore's take on Mike Moran spoke to the people of Britain in a way comics had never done before – an important and seminal step in Britain's blossoming comic scene.



LONE WOLF AND CUB

Details **Originally published** Lone Wolf And Cub (1970) **Publisher** Dark Horse **Writer** Kazuo Koike **Artist** Goseki Kojima
Collected in Lone Wolf And Cub: Vol 1 – The Assassin's Road **Available digitally** Dark Horse

Lone Wolf And Cub isn't just a classic piece of comics storytelling; it's a classic story. After being framed, disgraced and having his wife murdered, Ogami Itto gives his young son a choice; a ball or a sword. If the child crawled towards the ball, he would have killed him so he could reunite with his mother. The child, Daigoro, crawled towards the sword, and in doing sent both of them down the long path of vengeance.

Lone Wolf And Cub is an epic, with the original series running to 28 volumes. The central image looks absurd, but is actually the entire series wrapped up in one image: a father and a son, duty and love, honour and vengeance. Tragic, complex, action-packed and character-driven, it's astonishing, bloody and brilliant stuff. If you're interested in manga or the classics of modern comics then you must read this.

